

NT18 Enrichment

†1. Elder Donald J. Keyes: Rescuing Lost Lambs

“As Jackie and I drove into **Star Valley**, we enjoyed seeing an occasional flock of sheep sprinkled with dozens of baby lambs. Few things are more endearing than a baby lamb. As we drove down the busy road, we saw a small lamb outside the fence near the roadside. It was frantically running back and forth against the fence, trying to get back to the flock. I surmised that this little lamb was small enough to have pressed through an opening in the fence but was now unable to return.

“I was confident that if we didn’t stop to rescue the lamb, it would eventually wander into the nearby road and be injured or killed. I stopped the car and said to Jackie and our traveling companions in the backseat, “Wait here; this will take just a moment.”

“I naturally assumed with my total lack of lamb-herding experience that the frightened lamb would be glad to see me; after all, I had the best of intentions. I was there to save its life!

“But to my disappointment, the lamb was afraid and totally unappreciative of my efforts to save it. As I approached it, the little soul ran away from me as fast as it could along the fence. Seeing my plight, Jackie got out of the car to help. But even together we could not outmaneuver the quick little lamb.

“At this point the couple in the backseat, who had been thoroughly enjoying the rodeo, piled out of the car and joined in the rescue attempt. With all of our efforts we finally corralled the frightened little lamb against the fence. As I reached down to pick him up in my clean traveling clothes, I quickly noticed that he had the distinct aroma of the barnyard. It was then that I began to wonder, is this effort really worth it?

“As we picked up the lamb and lifted him over the fence to safety, he fought and kicked with all his might. But within moments he had found his mother and was pressed tightly and safely against her side. With our clothing a little disheveled but with great satisfaction and peace that we had made the right choice, we went on our way. (“[Parables of the Lost and Found](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 2011 see Rescuing Lost Lambs)

†2. Elder John K. Carmack: “Never Give Up. If you cannot seem to reach your daughter or son now, you can at least keep trying and keep loving them, for the very will to reach out, nurture, and extend help to another is an act of love that does not always go unnoticed.

President Joseph F. Smith offered advice that has helped me at difficult times: “Fathers, if you wish your children to be taught in the principles of the gospel, if you wish them to love the truth and understand it, if you wish them to be obedient to and united with you, love them! ... However wayward they might be, ... when you speak or talk to them, do it not in anger, do it not harshly, in a

condemning spirit. **Speak to them kindly. ... You can’t drive them; they won’t be driven**” (Gospel Doctrine, 5th ed. [1939], 316; cited in “[When Our Children Go Astray](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 1997).

Other stories of the Lost and Found or Prodigal Son:

“[She Wouldn’t Give Up on Me](#),” Sonya Konstans, in “Parables of the Lost and Found,” *Ensign*, Feb. 2011

“[With Love—from the Prodigal’s Sister](#),” Name Withheld, *Ensign*, June 1991.

†3. Stephen Glenn and Jane Nelson:

“1. Do you have more than one pair of shoes?

“2. Do you have more than one choice about what you will eat for each meal?

“3. Do you have access to your own means of transportation?

“4. Do you have more than one set of underwear? ...

“Fewer than 10 percent of all the people who have ever lived have been able to answer ‘yes’ to three or more of these questions at any one time in their lives.”

(*Raising Self-Reliant Children in a Self-Indulgent World*, 44-45; cited in [Prayers That Bring Miracles](#), 36-37)

†4. Elder Dallin H. Oaks: “In one of the times of spiritual and temporal adversity recorded in the Book of Mormon, **when the people of God were ‘suffering all manner of afflictions,’ the Lord commanded them to ‘give thanks in all things’ (Mosiah 26:38-39) ...**

“We give thanks for commandments. They are directions away from pitfalls, and they are invitations to blessings. Commandments mark the path and show us the way to happiness in this life and eternal life in the world to come...”

“When we give thanks in all things, we see hardships and adversities in the context of the purpose of life...”

There must be opposition in all things. We are meant to learn and grow through that opposition, through meeting our challenges, and through teaching others to do the same.” (“[Give Thanks in All Things](#),” *Ensign*, May 2003)

†5. Prodigal Young Woman near Jackson Hole: “Many years ago a young lady shared this experience with me. She is a remarkable disciple, and her life has come to typify the highest levels of Christian conduct and goodness, **but for a time in Junior High and High School, she strayed from the straight and narrow path and became lost, like the coin, the lamb, and the prodigal son.**

“Following her high school experiences, she traveled to Wyoming to work for a summer on a ‘Dude Ranch’ near Jackson Hole. Her parents were not pleased to have her so far away, but both recognized that their major function at that time was to extend love and support. Even

though she had been continually willing to talk to them, to admit her transgressions and weaknesses, she had ceased being willing to listen to their counsel. And so she went.

“She did not go un-loved, nor un-tutored. A marvelous bishop had worked with her for years, and the teachings of her parents had found a responsive, although often subdued, chord in her life. Thus, even when she did things that were wrong, she knew that they were wrong, and struggled with the differences between her beliefs and her actions.

“One evening she left the girls' dorm at the ranch. She was on the way to the Wranglers' Dorm—the dormitory where the young men employed by the ranch made their summer homes. She knew as she walked along that what she intended to do she should not do, and a part of her did not want to go on. But another, and usually stronger part, did. She told me that as she walked, she began to pray: ‘Heavenly Father, why don't you stop me.’

“And she got an answer. A message came clearly to her heart, a message something like this: ‘Daughter, I can't stop you. But if you will stop yourself, and turn around, I will help you.’

“She was so surprised by this unexpected response that she stopped walking. (She described this to me in great detail) She said, ‘I stopped, and then slowly turned around until I was facing back the way I had come. And for the first time in months, perhaps years, I felt the Spirit in my heart. It was as though the Father was by my side. I began to walk to back to my own room, and I was not alone.’ It was at that moment that her life began to change. As soon as she turned around and started home, ‘[her] Father saw [her], and had compassion, and ran, and fell on [her] neck, and kissed [her].’ (Luke 15:20) He then made the journey home by her side.”

...
“This young woman later married to wonderful young man, a returned missionary, in the Salt Lake Temple. She must have felt the power of the Spirit and the overflowing love--the rejoicing--of the Father and his angels as she knelt there in that holy place, clean and worthy and beautiful beyond words. The Father had brought forth the robe and the ring and the shoes, and killed the fatted calf to welcome her home.” (Ted L. Gibbons, [New Testament Lesson 18: “He Was Lost and Is Found,”](#) at LDSLiving, April 05, 2015)

†6. **Elder Gordon B. Hinckley:** “The boy in the parable wanted only to be a servant in his father's house, but his father, seeing him afar off, ran to meet him and kissed him, put a robe on his back, a ring on his hand, and shoes on his feet, and had a feast prepared for him.

“So it will be with you. If you will take the first timid step to return, you will find open arms to greet you and warm friends to make you welcome” (Gordon B.

Hinckley, “[Everything to Gain—Nothing to Lose](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1976, 95).

†7. **Elder Jeffrey R. Holland:** “As others seem to grow larger in our sight, we think we must therefore be smaller. So, unfortunately, we occasionally act that way.

How does this happen, especially when we wish so much that it would not? I think one of the reasons is that every day we see allurements of one kind or another that tell us what we have is not enough. Someone or something is forever telling us we need to be more handsome or more wealthy, more applauded or more admired than we see ourselves as being. We are told we haven't collected enough possessions or gone to enough fun places. We are bombarded with the message that on the world's scale of things we have been weighed in the balance and found wanting. Some days it is as if we have been locked in a cubicle of a great and spacious building where the only thing on the TV is a never-ending soap opera entitled *Vain Imaginations*” (“[The Other Prodigal](#),” *Ensign*, May 2002, 62).

†8. **President Boyd K. Packer:** “The gospel teaches us that relief from torment and guilt can be earned through repentance. Save for those few who defect to perdition after having known a fullness, there is no habit, no addiction, no rebellion, no transgression, on offense exempted from the promise of complete forgiveness.

...
“I repeat, save for the exception of the very few who defect to perdition, there is no habit, no addiction, no rebellion, no transgression, no apostasy, no crime exempted from the promise of complete forgiveness. That is the promise of the atonement of Christ” (“[The Brilliant Morning of Forgiveness](#),” *Ensign*, 1995, 22 and 23).

†9. **Harold B. Lee:** “But please do not misunderstand the true meaning of the scriptures. One may not wallow in the mire of filth and sin and conduct his life in a manner unlawful in the sight of God and then suppose that repentance will wipe out the effects of his sin and place him on the level he would have been on had he always lived a righteous and virtuous life. The Lord extends loving mercy and kindness in forgiving you of the sins you commit against Him or His work, but He can never remove the results of the sin you have committed against yourself in thus retarding your own advancement toward your eternal goal” (*Stand Ye In Holy Places*, 221).

Articles:

President Thomas S. Monson, “[With Hand and Heart](#),” *Ensign*, January 1995.

“When we treat people merely as they are, they may remain as they are. When we treat them as if they were what they should be, they may become what they should be.” Jesus changed the very nature of men. He changed their hearts. He looked beyond their faults and saw their worth. Through his love and outstretched hands he was able to lift others towards God. Do we have the will to do the same?

President Thomas S. Monson, “[The Divine Gift of Gratitude](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2010.

My beloved friend President Gordon B. Hinckley said, “When you walk with gratitude, you do not walk with arrogance and conceit and egotism, you walk with a spirit of thanksgiving that is becoming to you and will bless your lives.” [3]